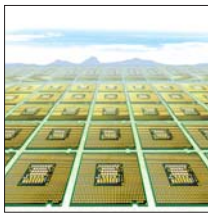




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Enhance

Your Own Porta-PC

No, we're not talking about laptops here—you can carry your PC around on a USB device, thanks to a neat tool called MojoPac

Nimish Chandiramani

Not too long ago, we gave you the low-down on some essential applications for your USB drive (*Life in a USB Nutshell*, *Digit* April 2006), but what if you didn't want the associated paranoia of mistakenly changing someone else's settings? Why shouldn't you be able to enjoy working on any PC in the same carefree manner that you would work on your own?

You might have heard about U3, the platform that lets you install any application directly to a Flash drive and use them anywhere. The great thing about this is that you don't need to wonder whether the application you're installing is portable or not—just install away. The downside? You'll need to buy a whole new drive that comes with U3, and if you ever tire of it or need the extra space for data, you can't get rid of it! Moreover, some applications now need re-writing for the U3 platform, and few vendors are inclined to do so.

So what if you want all the good things about U3, and not have to buy a new disk? Enter MojoPac!

What It Does

When you install MojoPac on your USB drive, it gives you your own virtual Windows XP environment, where you can install and use your applications. You'll find a 30-day trial of MojoPac on this month's CD, and it costs only \$29.95 (Rs 1350)—well worth it once you realise how much use it can be to you. The first of this feature list is its ability to turn any USB storage device into a MojoPC—Flash drive, hard drive, cell phone, and even your iPod!

Installation is a matter of a few minutes—just make sure your USB device is connected to your

PC, and choose it when the installer asks you to. It copies essential items from your Documents and Settings, Windows and Program Files folders, and also gives you the option of copying any other files that you want.

Running MojoPac for the first time is like running a fresh install of Windows XP—it shows you no installed programs, no matter how many are actually installed on the PC you've connected your drive to. Just like a Windows XP install, though, you can run the default applications that come with it. To start installing your applications, just pop in the installation CD or run the setup file.

How It Works

With the few essential files that it copies from your Windows installation, plus its own functionality, MojoPac successfully emulates a Windows XP installation, so any software you install on it thinks it's installing on to a full XP install. Technically, then, you don't even need to worry about violating the license agreements of the expensive software you invested in. If you need to use, say, Adobe Photoshop wherever you go, you can't go around installing it on every PC you work on—this would violate the single-user license and make you guilty of piracy. But install Photoshop on your MojoPac device, and you can use it on any Windows XP machine—and you don't have to worry about being a pirate any more!



Imaging Chaitanya Surpur
Photograph Amrut Patki